What can robots do?

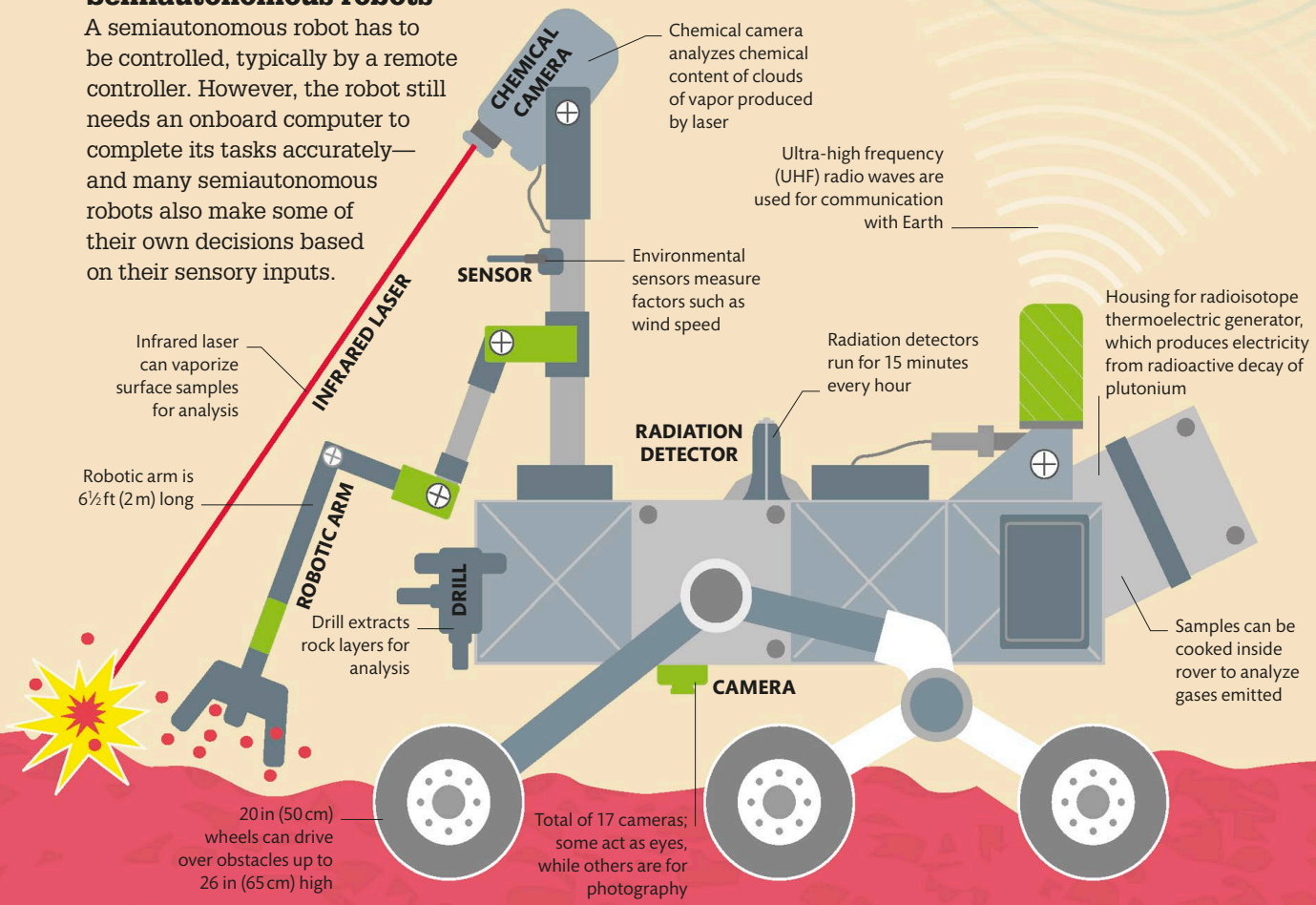
Some robots are completely autonomous, working without input from humans and making decisions based on the input they receive from their sensors. However, most robots are only semiautonomous.

Remote control
A robotic probe is controlled from Earth via radio signals—but can still do tasks unaided.

Signals may take between 4 and 24 minutes to reach Mars

Semiautonomous robots

A semiautonomous robot has to be controlled, typically by a remote controller. However, the robot still needs an onboard computer to complete its tasks accurately—and many semiautonomous robots also make some of their own decisions based on their sensory inputs.



Mars Curiosity Rover
NASA's Mars Science Laboratory, known as Curiosity, is a six-wheeled robot designed to withstand the harsh Martian atmosphere. It uses a wide range of scientific instruments to collect data and send it back to Earth.

THE MARS ROVER OPPORTUNITY WAS DESIGNED FOR A 90-DAY MISSION BUT REMAINED ACTIVE FOR 14 YEARS